This brings me to a fundamental point about what it means to be Indian in the twenty-first century. The Indian diaspora is said to be around twenty-five to thirty million strong and spans the world. Through hard work, education and entrepreneurship, its members have become very successful in fields ranging from business and politics to literature. With success has come a new confidence in its identity. Thanks to globalization and technology, these expatriate communities can now maintain business, personal and cultural links with India in ways that would have been unthinkable a generation ago. Richer and better connected, they share passions ranging from Bollywood to cricket with their cousins back in India.

Note that this is not a one-way relationship. Indians tend to be inordinately proud of the personal achievements of people of Indian origin even if they have had no direct link to the subcontinent. An Indian-origin governor of an American state, a Nobel Prize winner or a CEO of a multinational company can make headlines in Indian newspapers. In other words, both sides share a very palpable sense of shared identity. This is not unique to Indians since the Jewish and Chinese diasporas also share similar sentiments. The point is that India's civilizational nationhood includes people who are neither citizens nor live on the subcontinent. In recent years, the Indian Republic has tried to deal with this reality by creating, perhaps clumsily, different shades of citizenship in the form of Overseas Citizen of India and Person of Indian Origin. Such has been the journey of the 'global Indian': from the docks of Lothal to the boardrooms of London, New York and Singapore

## GONDWANA TO GURGAON

The journey from Gondwana to Gurgaon has been a long one. In this book, I have hopefully given the reader a sense of the twists and turns, the abrupt shifts as well as the surprising continuities. It is remarkable how the artifacts of this long history sit juxtaposed and piled up next to each other. The brand new city of Gurgaon, for instance, is being constructed right next